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How to Install Windows 11 Without a Microsoft Account

How-to By Avram Piltch last updated April 26, 2023

Maintain only a local account on your Windows 11 PC.

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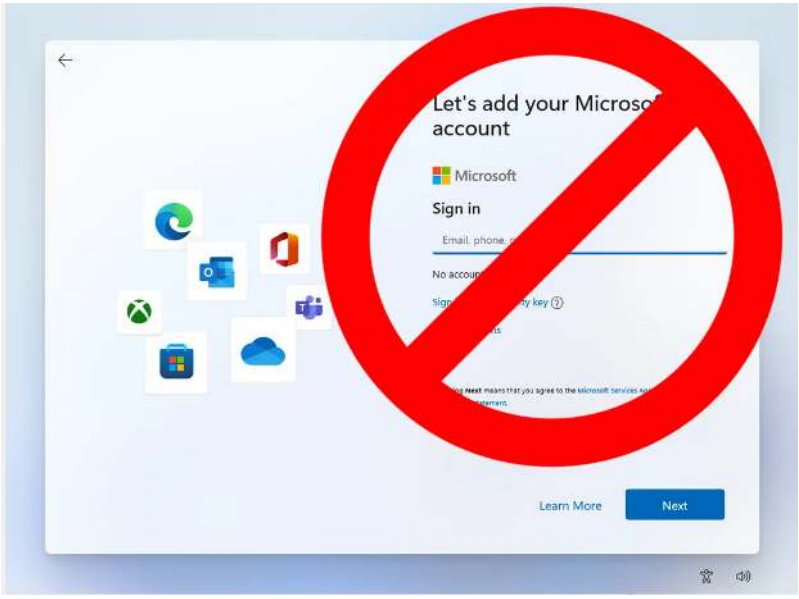

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By default, you must have (or create) a Microsoft account in order to install Windows 11 Home (and versions of Pro that are build 22H2 and up). Though Microsoft accounts are free, there are many reasons why you would want to install Windows 11 without one.

Maybe you want to use a local account because you are installing Windows 11 on a child's PC or on a PC that you plan to sell, give to a friend or donate to a charity (without giving other people access to personal data). Or perhaps you just like your privacy and don't want to create an account with Microsoft in the first place.

Whatever your reason for doing so, there's a relatively easy way to install Windows 11 without using a Microsoft account. We should note that Microsoft is trying to make it more difficult to set up a local Windows account so our instructions, shown below, have changed a bit recently.

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How to Install Windows 11 Without a Microsoft Account

There's a simple trick for setting up a local account that involves issuing a command to keep Windows from requiring Internet to install and then cutting off Internet at just the right time in the setup process. However, you can also prepare your install disk using Rufus, which removes the login requirement, a process we document further down this page.

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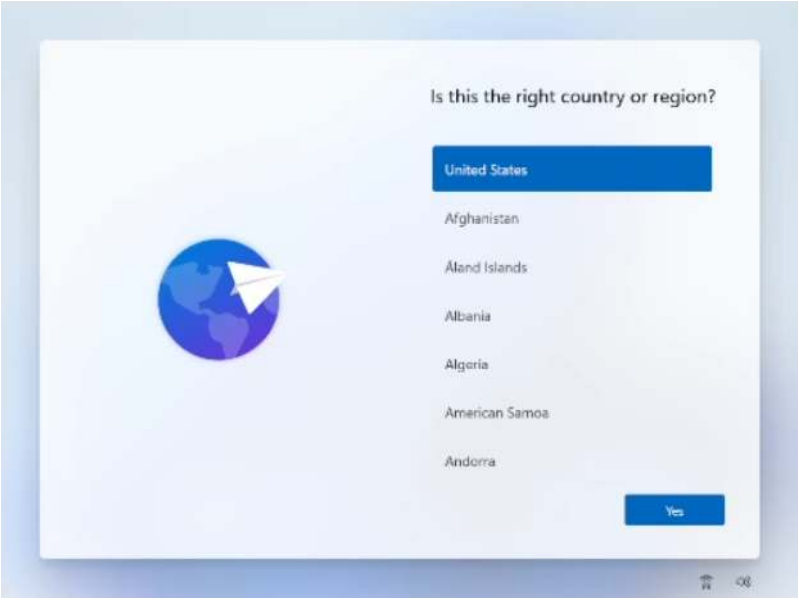
If you've already downloaded and created a Windows 11 boot disk with Rufus or otherwise, follow these steps to set up without a Microsoft account.

1. **Follow the Windows 11 install process until you get to the "choose a country" screen.**



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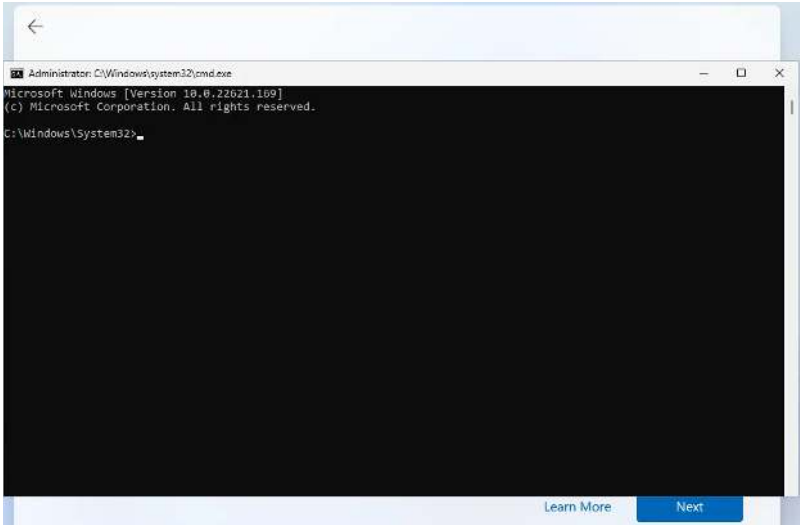
Now's the time to cut off the Internet. However, before you do, you need to issue a command that prevents Windows 11 from forcing you to have an Internet connection.

2. **Hit Shift + F10**. A command prompt appears.



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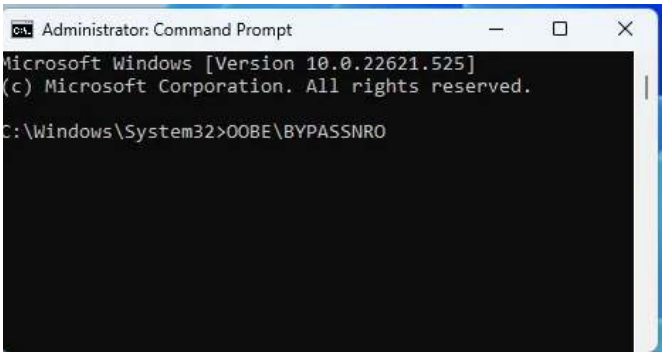
3. **Type *OOBE\BYPASSNRO*** to disable the Internet connection requirement.



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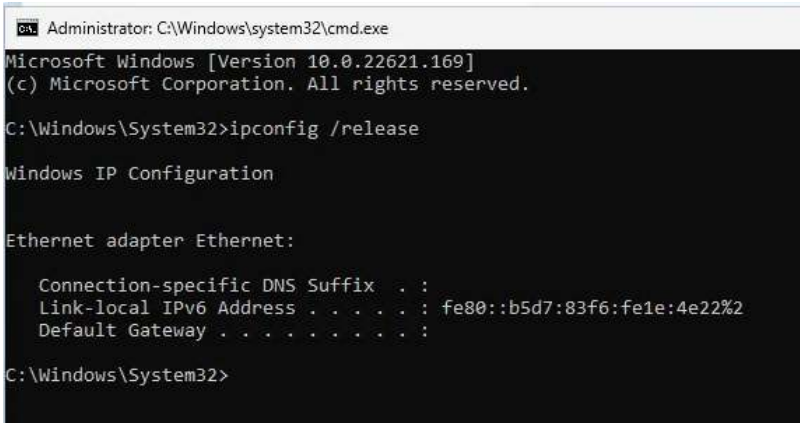
The computer will reboot and return you to this screen.

4. **Hit Shift + F10 again** and this time **Type *ipconfig /release.*** Then **hit Enter** to disable the Internet.



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5. **Close the command prompt**.

6. **Continue with the installation,** choosing the region. keyboard and second keyboard option.

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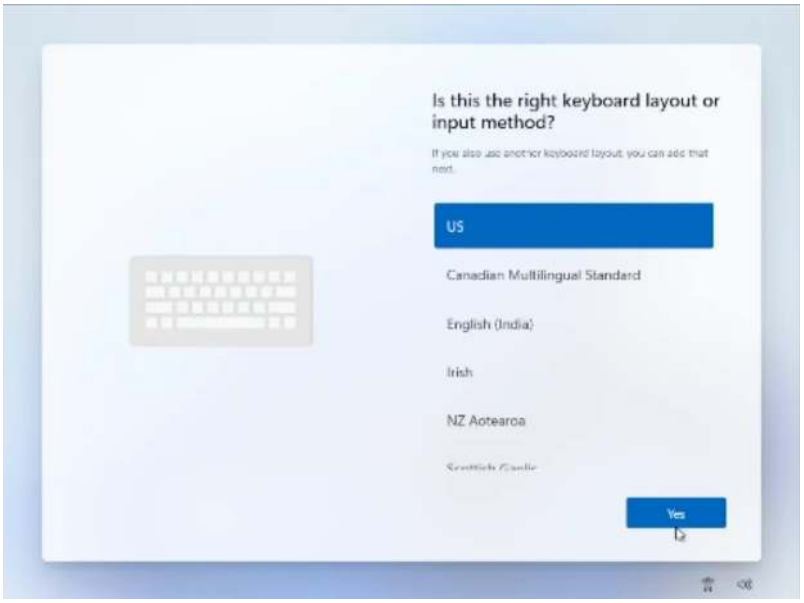

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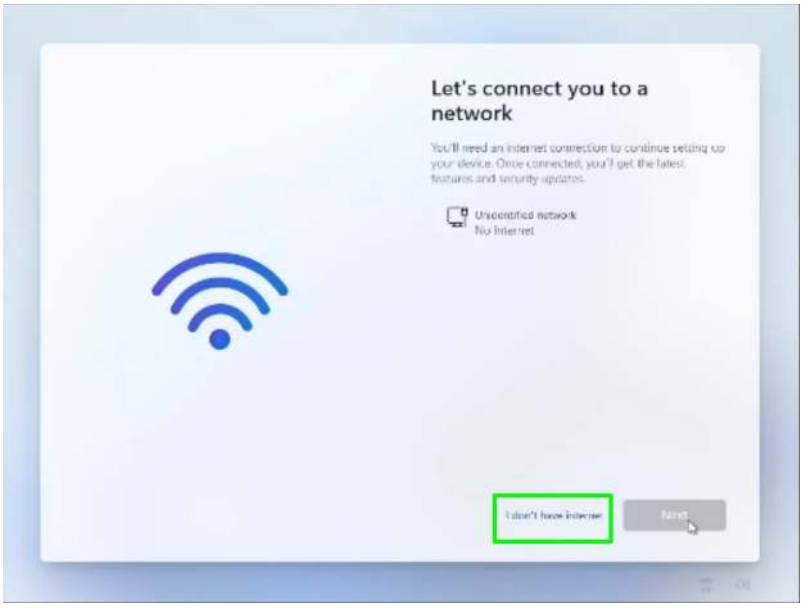
A screen saying "Let's connect you to a network" appears, warning you that you need Internet.

7. **Click "I don't have Internet"** to continue.



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A new login screen appears asking "Who's going to use this device?"

8. **Enter a username** you want to use for your local account and **click Next**.

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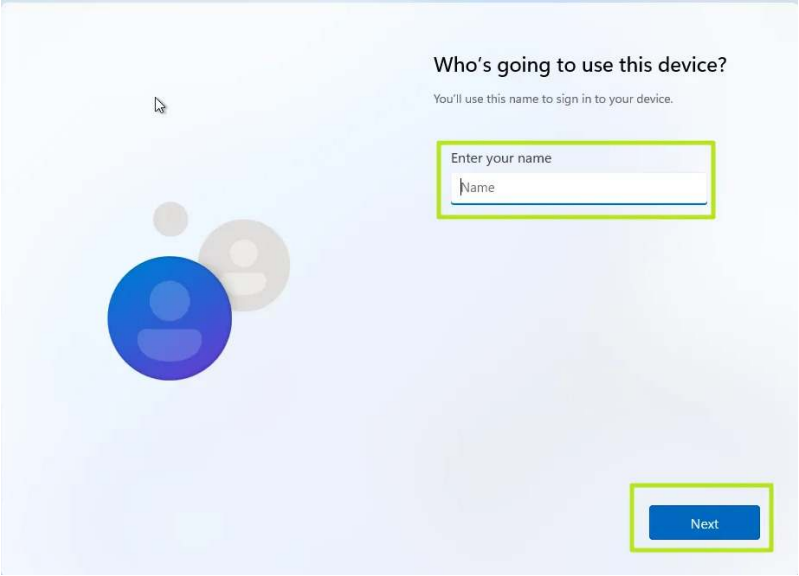

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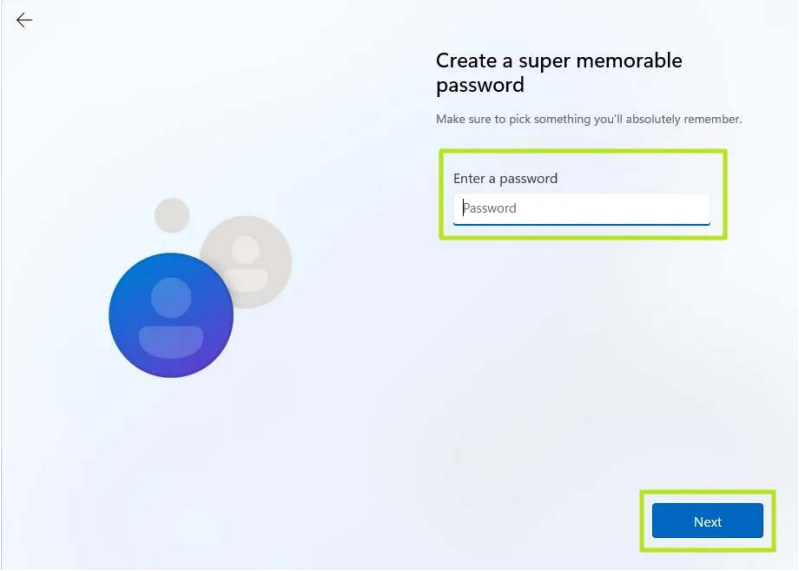
9. **Enter a password** you would like to use and **click Next**. You can also leave this field blank and have no password, but that's not recommended.



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10. **Complete the rest of the install process** as you normally would.

How to Create a Windows 11 Install Disk that Allows Bypassing Microsoft Accounts

You can also create an install disk that has the "no Internet required" setting built into the setup process.

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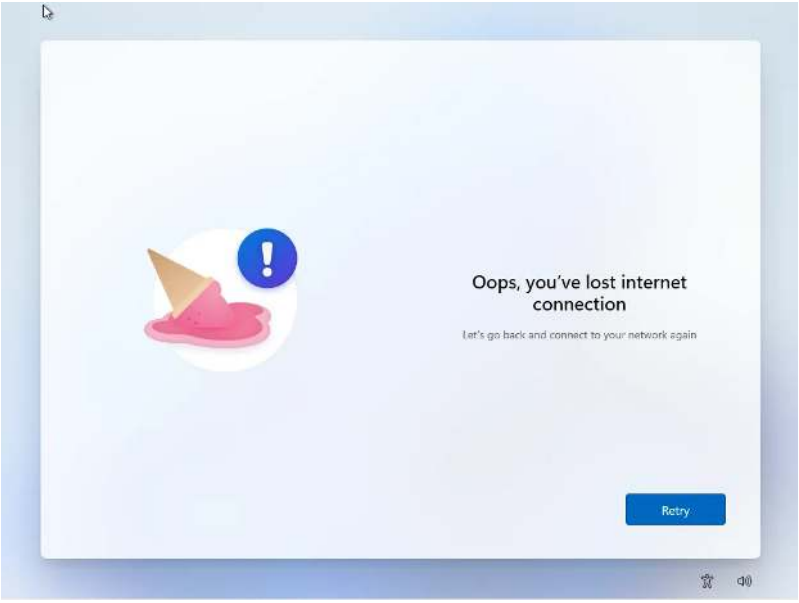

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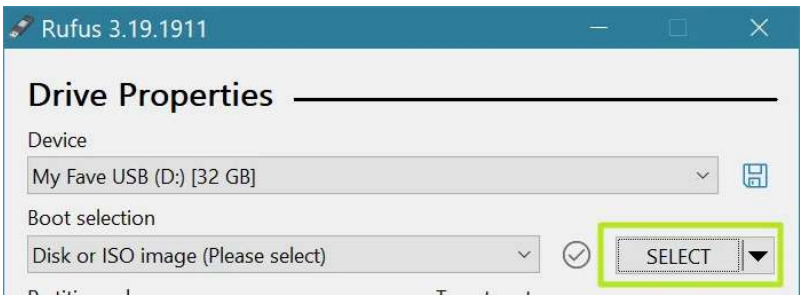
Here's how to make a Windows 11 install disk that will let you disconnect from the Internet during setup so you can create a local account instead of using a Microsoft one.

1. **Download the Windows 11 ISO file** for Windows 11 22H2 (build 22621.169 or higher). As of this writing, you can only get the ISO for that build directly by using UUP Dump. We explain how to perform this process in our how to download a Windows 11 ISO file article.

2. **Insert a USB Flash drive** you want to use as an install disk if one is not already inserted. Note that this drive will be completely erased during the process and it must be at least 8GB. If you are just installing Windows in a virtual machine, you can create an ISO file instead of writing directly to a Flash drive, but we'll assume you're not doing that here.

3. **Download and launch Rufus** version 3.19 or higher. There is no installation process, but you may be asked to confirm permissions by Windows User Account control.

4. **Select the USB drive** from the menu in Rufus if it's not already selected.



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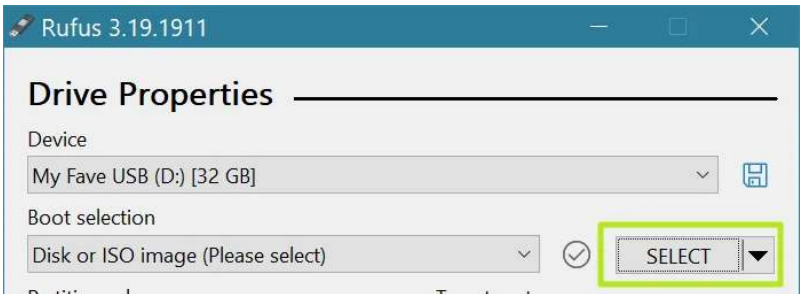
5. **Click Select** and **choose the ISO file**.



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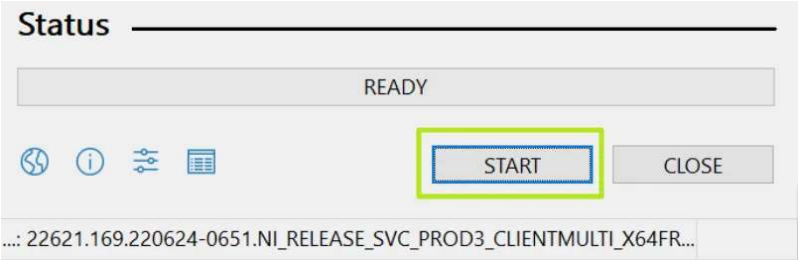
6. **Click Start** at the bottom of the Rufus window.



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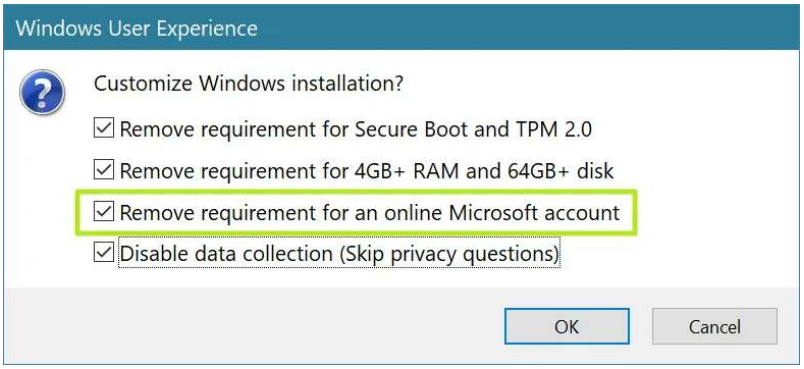
A dialog box appears with a few options for bypassing Windows 11 install requirements.

7. **Toggle "Remove requirement for an online Microsoft account" to on** and **click OK.** You may also want to toggle on the other options, which include Removing the Secure Boot / TPM 2.0, RAM and Storage requirements. But if your computer meets those requirements, it doesn't pay to do that.



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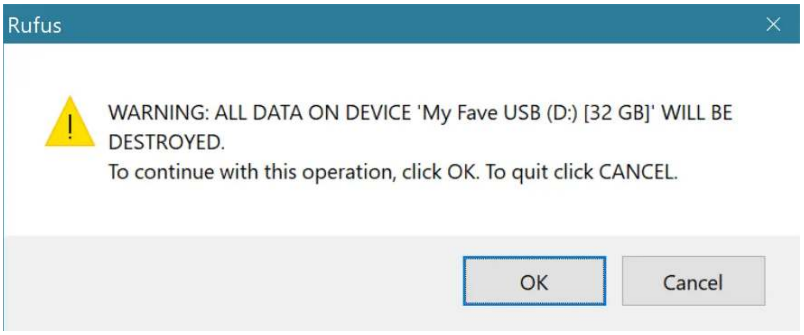
8. **Click OK** if warned that Rufus will destroy all data on the USB Flash drive. It is expected to overwrite all contents of the drive.



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Rufus will take a few minutes to copy files to the USB Flash drive. When it's done, you will have a bootable Flash drive.

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> ***maestro0428*** **said:**
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maestro0428

I know right?! But as soon as those sticks came out, no other change was made and when I booted, it said activate windows again, but with a MS account. Its fixed now, still on local account, but I don't want to have to do all this to keep it activated as much as I change hardware. Thankfully, my...

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You should contact Microsoft, ram shouldn't cause that to happen. https://answers.microsoft.com/en-us/windows/forum/all/reactivating-microsoft-win-10-licence-after-memory/06b38149-d01c-4ec7-ad89-5ed36e677ebe

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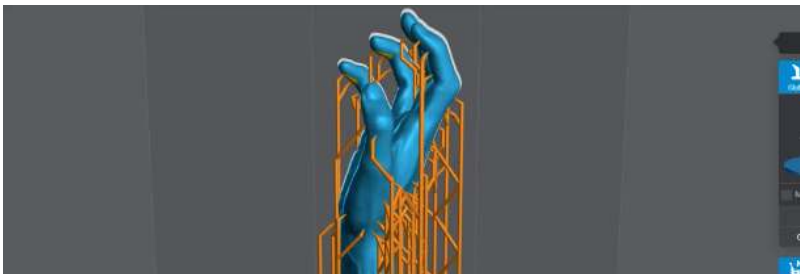

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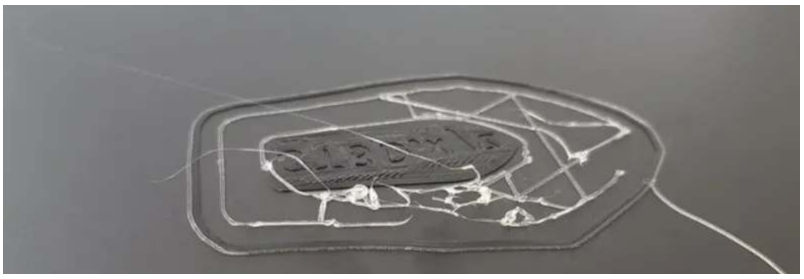

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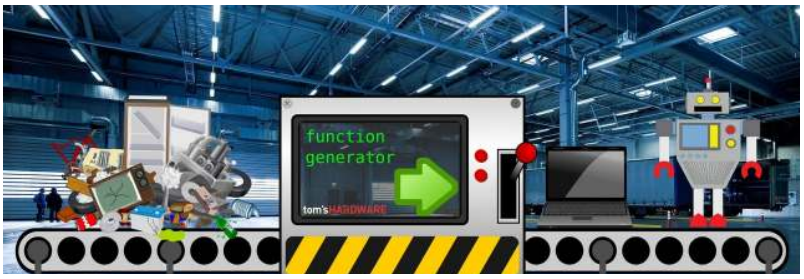

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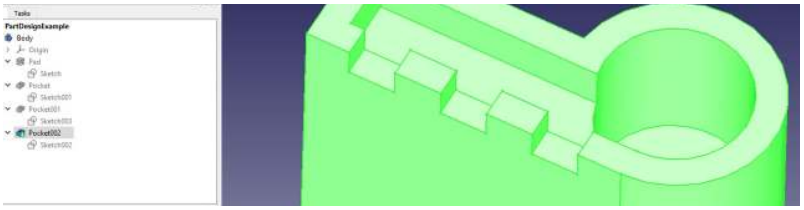

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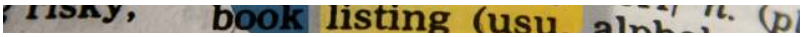

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